

IN CONTEXT

Orchestral recording

Elgar was a pioneer of recorded music. In the early 20th century, records of famous singers were marketed, but very few recordings of orchestras had been attempted before 1914, when the Gramophone Company signed Elgar to conduct his most popular works. In 1931, as technology began to transform the quality of recorded sound, Elgar was invited to inaugurate EMI's new Abbey Road studio, conducting the London Symphony Orchestra in his Falstaff suite. His most famous recording was a 1932 performance of his Violin Concerto with violinist Yehudi Menuhin, who was then just 16 years old.



GRAMOPHONE AT ELGAR'S BIRTHPLACE
MUSEUM, BROADHEATH